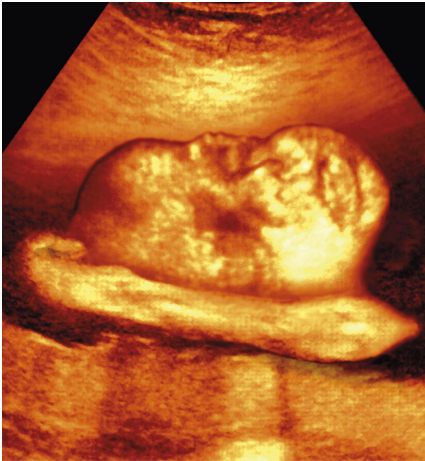




YOU ARE **32 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

51 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

In this image of the baby lying on their side, the arm is positioned beneath the head and is partly outside of the 3-D view, allowing structures within the arm to be seen. Part of the bones in the elbow and forearm show here as bright reflections.

**“ To get used to the fact that your newborn will arrive very soon,
start focusing on life after the birth ”**

Friends and family might now begin talking about what will happen after the birth and what it will be like for you to have a baby.

If this is your first baby, it may be hard for you to imagine what life will be like with your newborn, and even if you have had a baby before, you've never had a second or third and so you don't know what it will be like to have another one. Of course, you know that life will continue, but it can be difficult to see past the labor to the realities of life with a newborn. As ever, keep talking to those close to you about how you feel, be it excited or scared and unprepared (usually all three in rapid succession). Talk about what you think or hope it will be like after the baby is born, for example when are grandparents and other key people going to visit, and whether you would like a christening or naming party—or perhaps neither of these. This may help you get used to the idea that not only are you pregnant but there is a baby coming.

ASK A DOCTOR

How will I benefit from going to prenatal classes? You'll get the opportunity to share information, ideas, fears, and concerns about childbirth in a comfortable environment, and to discuss and decide upon issues that will affect the way you choose to give birth. You'll also meet other parents-to-be. Often friendships formed at classes continue after the birth as you support each other in your new parenting role. In most classes, you'll be given advice about:

- **Tried-and-true labor techniques**, such as breathing through the pain, massage, suitable sustenance, and some positive visualization exercises.
- **Pain-relief options** and a range of natural alternatives (see [Pain-relief options](#)).
- **How to present** (and preserve) your [birth plan](#).
- **The practical and emotional support** a birth partner can offer.
- **The items required** for a hospital or home birth (see [Items for your hospital bag](#) and [Ask a midwife](#)).